

BUSINESS CREATIONS AND BANKRUPTCIES IN FRANCE: DOUBLE-DIGIT GROWTH IN BUSINESS CREATIONS, LOWER GROWTH IN BANKRUPTCIES, AND STABLE NON-PERFORMING LOANS

ECO CHARTS | BUSINESS CREATIONS AND BANKRUPTCIES IS A NEW PUBLICATION AIMED AT PROVIDING AN OVERVIEW OF THE DYNAMICS OF BUSINESS CREATIONS AND BANKRUPTCIES IN FRANCE, AS WELL AS THE RISKS ASSOCIATED WITH THE LATTER. WE WILL PUBLISH REGULAR UPDATES TO THIS PUBLICATION ON A QUARTERLY BASIS.



BNP PARIBAS

The bank
for a changing
world

Double-digit growth in business creations, a slowdown in bankruptcies and stable non-performing loans

- Business creations rose by 12% y/y in the first eight months of 2026, marking an acceleration compared with the growth seen in 2025 (+5.3%).
- This increase was driven by sectors associated with new information and communication technologies, where the trend is gaining momentum.
- Meanwhile, business bankruptcies rose by 5.3% y/y from January to July, according to the data from the Banque de France (vs +3.6% y/y in 2025). After a more pronounced rise in the first quarter (+8% y/y), this increase has since slowed. This moderation could continue, as, according to Altares, payment delays have decreased to an average of 12.3 days in the second quarter of 2026 (14.1 days a year earlier), compared with the European average of 13.1 days.
- The rise in business bankruptcies is most pronounced in the services sector, which has simultaneously seen an increase in business creations. This trend is clear in the retail sector, with a 13% increase in business creations since the beginning of 2026, while business bankruptcies are up 3%.
- In construction and manufacturing, business bankruptcies have been declining since the second quarter of 2026.
- The level of the average ratio of non-performing loans is moderately high and has remained stable for the past year (4.0% of total loans and advances in Q2 2026). More cyclical than in other sectors, the ratio of non-performing loans in construction reached its highest level since 2019 at 9.5%.
- The share of underperforming loans, but not yet non-performing (in Stage 2, according to IFRS 9 terminology), which provides an indication of the future trend in non-performing loans, is stable, standing at 15.4% q/q, and remains below its all-time high (16.1%).
- Despite a significant rise since 2021, the economic weight of bankruptcies – which allows them to be weighted by a proxy for company size – remains, on average, below its Q1 2025 peak (0.53 compared with 0.61, respectively). However, the economic weight of bankrupt small businesses stands at a historically high level (2.11).

For more information, please refer to our publication:

[Chart of the week | French corporates: peaks in creations put peaks in bankruptcies into perspective. July 22, 2026 – Economic Research – BNP Paribas](#)



BNP PARIBAS

The bank for a changing world

Strong growth in business creations, moderate increase in bankruptcies

The growth in business creations accelerated in 2026 (+12%) after +5.3% in 2025

Business creations	12-month sum y/y change																															
	Actual data	Jul-Aug 26	26Q2	26Q1	25Q4	25Q3	25Q2	25Q1	24Q4	24Q3	24Q2	24Q1	23Q4	23Q3	23Q2	23Q1	22Q4	22Q3	22Q2	22Q1	21Q4	21Q3	21Q2	21Q1	20Q4	20Q3	20Q2	20Q1	19Q4	19Q3	19Q2	19Q1
Total	1 263 516	12%	10%	14%	9%	11%	3%	-2%	0%	0%	12%	13%	2%	3%	0%	-6%	6%	6%	-7%	-1%	-2%	-6%	55%	32%	17%	22%	-18%	-4%	16%	14%	14%	19%
Industry	73 387	1%	-3%	9%	7%	8%	1%	-8%	-3%	6%	17%	29%	9%	2%	11%	2%	19%	22%	6%	16%	10%	12%	68%	27%	14%	12%	-15%	15%	47%	42%	26%	17%
Construction	91 044	9%	7%	9%	3%	4%	-5%	-13%	-12%	-4%	11%	9%	-4%	-4%	-12%	-10%	8%	5%	-1%	2%	-4%	-7%	55%	17%	10%	12%	-25%	4%	22%	21%	12%	13%
Retail trade	188 726	16%	9%	14%	11%	22%	14%	1%	1%	-2%	8%	18%	6%	4%	-1%	-9%	-3%	-9%	-23%	-22%	-26%	-25%	23%	38%	34%	39%	-2%	-10%	6%	1%	5%	11%
Transports	112 686	5%	-11%	3%	-8%	3%	9%	18%	22%	16%	37%	33%	22%	23%	4%	-18%	-15%	-27%	-46%	-43%	-28%	-21%	75%	117%	67%	71%	-5%	-21%	-2%	4%	24%	57%
Accommodation and catering	49 713	6%	7%	8%	11%	7%	7%	5%	-1%	9%	22%	21%	9%	10%	5%	1%	15%	6%	0%	-32%	-32%	-31%	68%	46%	30%	34%	-44%	0%	17%	15%	14%	16%
Information & communication	97 396	51%	49%	35%	29%	18%	-5%	-1%	-3%	-9%	21%	15%	5%	16%	8%	5%	17%	19%	3%	15%	11%	12%	52%	29%	12%	13%	-9%	-1%	22%	14%	18%	20%
Financial services	28 507	-13%	-7%	-3%	-13%	-10%	-13%	-18%	-3%	2%	8%	13%	-3%	-3%	-9%	-11%	2%	6%	1%	12%	17%	15%	79%	27%	7%	8%	-16%	8%	22%	19%	12%	19%
Real estate	40 692	0%	2%	11%	12%	12%	7%	4%	5%	-4%	-6%	-12%	-18%	-12%	-8%	-8%	2%	2%	-3%	5%	2%	1%	74%	31%	20%	31%	-17%	5%	23%	19%	17%	22%
Business services	337 351	16%	19%	22%	16%	17%	3%	0%	0%	-3%	6%	6%	-2%	1%	4%	-2%	15%	21%	8%	21%	13%	3%	50%	18%	6%	9%	-19%	-2%	20%	18%	18%	18%
Education, health, social services	112 263	6%	4%	10%	6%	6%	3%	-3%	1%	0%	5%	8%	-1%	-2%	-3%	-16%	-3%	8%	2%	19%	16%	7%	59%	21%	2%	6%	-28%	-9%	12%	13%	6%	9%

Reading notes : For each individual sector, the highest increase in the number of business creations is shown in the darkest shade of green. The highest decrease is shown in the darkest shade of red.

After accelerating sharply in the first quarter, the growth in business bankruptcies slowed

Business bankruptcies	12-month sum y/y change																															
	Actual data	Jul-26	26Q2	26Q1	25Q4	25Q3	25Q2	25Q1	24Q4	24Q3	24Q2	24Q1	23Q4	23Q3	23Q2	23Q1	22Q4	22Q3	22Q2	22Q1	21Q4	21Q3	21Q2	21Q1	20Q4	20Q3	20Q2	20Q1	19Q4	19Q3	19Q2	19Q1
Total	70605	2%	5%	8%	0%	6%	5%	4%	12%	11%	21%	25%	41%	24%	41%	47%	58%	52%	51%	37%	3%	-14%	12%	-32%	-44%	-29%	-56%	-30%	-8%	-11%	-4%	4%
Industry	4442	-2%	-1%	7%	1%	10%	3%	0%	8%	2%	10%	11%	18%	22%	29%	73%	82%	62%	63%	50%	5%	-11%	10%	-43%	-45%	-33%	-53%	-28%	-23%	-12%	-7%	-4%
Construction	14351	-7%	-3%	5%	-12%	3%	-3%	1%	17%	12%	40%	35%	54%	27%	39%	50%	49%	44%	36%	27%	17%	-3%	40%	-31%	-52%	-36%	-65%	-30%	-9%	-11%	-5%	-1%
Retail trade	14073	4%	3%	6%	1%	3%	1%	-3%	5%	10%	19%	22%	36%	16%	37%	47%	56%	61%	57%	44%	7%	-14%	9%	-37%	-47%	-29%	-56%	-26%	-2%	-9%	-4%	2%
Transports	3235	-7%	-6%	12%	6%	-1%	21%	3%	21%	28%	32%	43%	58%	19%	24%	34%	39%	49%	70%	39%	9%	2%	26%	-33%	-49%	-30%	-63%	-25%	6%	-14%	9%	12%
Accommodation and catering	9721	10%	11%	5%	7%	6%	9%	14%	5%	9%	11%	12%	42%	27%	58%	68%	121%	92%	105%	102%	-17%	-36%	-31%	-57%	-48%	-25%	-51%	-32%	-11%	-13%	-6%	6%
Information & communication	2123	0%	4%	8%	-3%	1%	6%	16%	19%	16%	17%	9%	42%	37%	59%	53%	49%	32%	44%	38%	-5%	3%	15%	-29%	-25%	-32%	-51%	-10%	-4%	10%	-5%	-2%
Financial services	1767	18%	6%	19%	0%	-10%	-1%	-6%	15%	21%	38%	37%	35%	38%	34%	40%	70%	66%	38%	51%	-10%	-15%	0%	-27%	-31%	-35%	-38%	-32%	-11%	5%	-11%	21%
Real estate	2648	8%	16%	-2%	4%	6%	-3%	-6%	7%	30%	36%	63%	67%	17%	67%	36%	38%	33%	-17%	-2%	-8%	-14%	59%	17%	-29%	-7%	-52%	-37%	0%	-5%	4%	-4%
Business services	9061	7%	15%	10%	3%	12%	8%	11%	19%	14%	20%	30%	44%	32%	34%	40%	28%	37%	44%	18%	8%	-15%	24%	-21%	-34%	-22%	-56%	-28%	-9%	-22%	6%	11%
Education, health, social services	7229	4%	10%	19%	9%	16%	18%	8%	17%	4%	1%	16%	30%	26%	51%	39%	68%	53%	70%	44%	-7%	-20%	-18%	-25%	-40%	-27%	-48%	-43%	-12%	-8%	-6%	13%

Reading notes : For each individual sector, the highest increase in the number of business bankruptcies is shown in the darkest shade of red. The highest decrease is shown in the darkest shade of green. The COVID-19 period (2020-23) is not highlighted to avoid skewing the calculations

Sources : Insee, Banque de France, BNP Paribas



BNP PARIBAS

La banque d'un monde qui change

Non-performing loans ratio have remained almost unchanged year-on-year

The deterioration in the quality of corporate loans is limited, but the construction sector and small businesses are more severely affected

	26Q2	26Q1	25Q4	25Q3	25Q2	25Q1	24Q4	24Q3	24Q2	24Q1	23Q4	23Q3	23Q2	23Q1	22Q4	22Q3	22Q2	22Q1	21Q4	21Q3	21Q2	21Q1	20Q4	20Q3	20Q2	20Q1	19Q4	19Q3	19Q2	19Q1
Non-performing loans ratio	4,0%	3,9%	3,9%	3,9%	3,8%	3,8%	3,7%	3,9%	3,8%	3,7%	3,6%	3,6%	3,6%	3,5%	3,4%	3,3%	3,3%	3,4%	3,5%	3,8%	3,9%	3,9%	3,9%	4,0%	3,9%	3,8%	3,9%	4,2%	4,2%	4,3%
o/w SMEs	5,2%	5,1%	5,0%	5,1%	5,0%	4,8%	4,7%	4,7%	4,6%	4,5%	4,4%	4,3%	4,2%	4,0%	4,0%	4,0%	3,9%	4,0%	4,0%	4,2%	4,3%	4,3%	4,3%	4,5%	4,8%	4,9%	5,0%	5,2%	5,8%	6,0%
o/w manufacturing	4,2%	4,1%	4,0%	4,0%	3,9%	4,3%	4,3%	4,3%	4,2%	4,3%	3,9%	4,0%	3,9%	4,0%	3,9%	4,0%	4,2%	4,2%	4,1%	4,7%	4,9%	5,0%	5,0%	4,8%	4,5%	3,9%	4,2%	4,6%	4,5%	4,4%
o/w construction	9,5%	8,7%	8,9%	9,0%	8,7%	9,0%	8,1%	8,3%	8,3%	8,1%	7,7%	7,4%	7,1%	7,0%	7,0%	7,4%	7,4%	7,2%	7,2%	7,6%	7,7%	7,5%	7,7%	8,3%	7,5%	8,0%	8,7%	8,4%	8,3%	8,7%
o/w retail	4,8%	5,0%	4,9%	4,9%	4,5%	4,3%	4,3%	4,3%	4,1%	4,3%	4,2%	4,2%	4,2%	3,8%	4,0%	4,1%	4,1%	4,1%	4,2%	4,5%	4,6%	4,7%	4,8%	5,2%	4,9%	4,9%	4,9%	5,0%	4,8%	4,9%
o/w services	3,8%	3,7%	3,5%	3,5%	3,5%	3,4%	3,3%	3,4%	3,3%	3,3%	3,2%	3,0%	2,9%	2,8%	2,8%	2,8%	2,8%	2,9%	3,0%	3,2%	3,3%	3,3%	3,2%	3,4%	3,4%	3,3%	3,4%	3,7%	3,7%	4,0%
Share of underperforming loans (stage 2 IFRS 9)	13,5%	13,6%	13,3%	13,9%	13,7%	13,4%	13,3%	13,6%	13,2%	13,3%	12,9%	12,8%	12,2%	12,9%	13,6%	15,3%	15,4%	15,1%	14,2%	14,4%	14,2%	13,8%	13,5%	11,3%						
o/w SMEs	15,4%	15,4%	15,2%	15,8%	15,7%	15,4%	15,2%	14,8%	14,7%	14,5%	13,6%	13,4%	13,1%	13,6%	13,6%	16,1%	15,7%	15,3%	15,0%	14,4%	13,7%	13,2%	12,6%	11,1%						
Economic weight of bankruptcies	0,53	0,53	0,51	0,51	0,52	0,61	0,60	0,59	0,56	0,47	0,45	0,43	0,42	0,37	0,32	0,28	0,24	0,21	0,20	0,19	0,20	0,24	0,24	0,27	0,36	0,36	0,38	0,38	0,32	0,32
o/w ISE and large firms	0,14	0,14	0,10	0,08	0,14	0,14	0,18	0,17	0,14	0,16	0,12	0,12	0,12	0,08	0,07	0,08	0,03	0,03	0,09	0,08	0,11	0,30	0,26	0,26	0,52	0,34	0,34	0,34	0,06	0,05
o/w medium	0,61	0,63	0,68	0,63	0,64	0,59	0,53	0,54	0,48	0,48	0,46	0,42	0,40	0,34	0,29	0,23	0,21	0,18	0,15	0,15	0,15	0,17	0,17	0,21	0,27	0,34	0,37	0,36	0,42	0,39
o/w micro and unknown	0,54	0,52	0,52	0,53	0,53	0,57	0,58	0,56	0,55	0,49	0,48	0,45	0,45	0,43	0,37	0,33	0,30	0,26	0,24	0,23	0,24	0,23	0,24	0,27	0,29	0,34	0,36	0,37	0,38	0,37
o/w small	2,11	2,13	1,77	1,83	1,74	1,72	1,64	1,63	1,52	1,44	1,58	1,47	1,42	1,31	0,96	0,74	0,57	0,42	0,39	0,31	0,33	0,37	0,46	0,54	0,63	0,75	0,72	0,75	0,72	0,68
o/w very small	0,91	0,88	0,83	0,85	0,81	1,52	1,49	1,47	1,42	0,73	0,68	0,66	0,61	0,52	0,48	0,39	0,38	0,33	0,27	0,25	0,20	0,18	0,21	0,25	0,28	0,36	0,41	0,47	0,51	0,5
Share of 90+ days past due payments	0,6%	0,6%	0,6%	0,6%	0,6%	0,5%	0,6%	0,5%	0,6%	0,6%	0,6%	0,7%	0,7%	0,6%	0,6%	0,6%	0,7%	0,7%	0,7%	0,9%	2,0%	2,1%	4,9%	2,1%	11,7%	13,3%	0,5%	0,4%	0,4%	0,5%

Reading notes : For each individual indicator, the highest level is shown in the darkest shade of red. The lowest level is shown in the darkest shade of green.

Source : Banque de France, BCE, EBA, INSEE, Urssaf



BNP PARIBAS

La banque d'un monde qui change

Sources

Variable	Source	Frequency	Definition
Business bankruptcies	Banque de France	Monthly	Companies subject to collective proceedings (receivership and judicial liquidation). Monthly data from the Banque de France aggregated over a quarter to minimise the risk of calendar effects
Business creations	Insee	Monthly	Survey of business creations (all types, companies, sole traders, micro-entrepreneurs). Monthly data from INSEE aggregated over a quarter to minimise the risk of calendar effects
Non performing loans ratio	EBA	Quarterly	Gross non performing loans and advances at amortised cost / Total gross loans and advances at amortised cost
Share of underperforming loans (Stage 2 IFRS 9)	BCE	Quarterly	Loans and advances in Stage 2 / Total loans and advances. Loans and advances at amortised cost and at fair value through equity
Economic weight of bankruptcies	Banque de France	Monthly	Total outstanding bank loans to newly bankrupt NFCs over a one-year period, calculated as the figure for the month in which the firm is declared bankrupt, relative to the average outstanding bank loans to both healthy and bankrupt NFCs during the same period.
Share of 90+ days past due payments	URSSAF	Monthly	Contributions still to be collected by Urssaf / Amount of contributions due to Urssaf



Isabelle Mateos y Lago Group Chief Economist	+33 1 87 74 01 97	isabelle.mateosylago@bnpparibas.com
Hélène Baudchon Deputy Chief Economist, Head of Global Macroeconomic Research	+33 1 58 16 03 63	helene.baudchon@bnpparibas.com
Stéphane Alby Maghreb, Middle East	+33 1 42 98 02 04	stephane.alby@bnpparibas.com
Lucie Barette Europe, Germany, Italy, Spain	+33 1 87 74 02 08	lucie.barette@bnpparibas.com
Anis Bensaidani United States, Japan	+33 1 87 74 01 51	anis.bensaidani@bnpparibas.com
Céline Choulet Banking Economics	+33 1 43 16 95 54	celine.choulet@bnpparibas.com
Stéphane Colliac Head of Advanced Economies – France	+33 1 42 98 26 77	stephane.colliac@bnpparibas.com
Guillaume Derrien Europe, Eurozone – World Trade	+33 1 55 77 71 89	guillaume.a.derrien@bnpparibas.com
Pascal Devaux Middle East, Western Balkans – Energy	+33 1 43 16 95 51	pascal.devaux@bnpparibas.com
Hélène Drouot Latin America	+33 1 42 98 33 00	helene.drouot@bnpparibas.com
François Faure Head of Country Risk – Türkiye – Argentina	+33 1 42 98 79 82	francois.faure@bnpparibas.com
Salim Hammad Head of Data & Analytics – Brazil	+33 1 42 98 74 26	salim.hammad@bnpparibas.com
Thomas Humblot Banking Economics	+33 1 40 14 30 77	thomas.humblot@bnpparibas.com
Cynthia Kalasopatan Antoine Central Europe, Ukraine	+33 1 53 31 59 32	cynthia.kalasopatanantoine@bnpparibas.com
Johanna Melka Asia	+33 1 58 16 05 84	johanna.melka@bnpparibas.com
Marianne Mueller Europe, United Kingdom, Portugal, Greece	+33 1 40 14 48 11	marianne.mueller@bnpparibas.com
Christine Peltier Head of Emerging economies – Asia	+33 1 42 98 56 27	christine.peltier@bnpparibas.com
Lucas Plé Sub-Saharan Africa, Colombia, Central America	+33 1 40 14 50 18	lucas.ple@bnpparibas.com
Jean-Luc Proutat Head of Economic Projections	+33 1 58 16 73 32	jean-luc.proutat@bnpparibas.com
Laurent Quignon Head of Banking Economics	+33 1 42 98 56 54	laurent.quignon@bnpparibas.com
Tarik Rharrab Data scientist	+33 1 43 16 95 56	tarik.rharrab@bnpparibas.com
Mickaëlle Fils Marie-Luce Media contact	+33 1 42 98 48 59	mickaëlle.filsmarie-luce@bnpparibas.com

The information and opinions contained in this document have been obtained from, or are based on, public sources believed to be reliable, but there is no guarantee of the accuracy, completeness or fitness for any particular purpose of such information and such information may not have been independently verified by BNPP or by any person. None of BNPP, any of its subsidiary undertakings or affiliates or its members, directors, officers, agents or employees accepts any responsibility or liability whatsoever or makes any representation or warranty, express or implied, as to the accuracy and completeness of the information or any opinions based thereon and contained in this document and it should not be relied upon as such. This document does not constitute research, as defined under MIFID II, or form any part of any offer to sell or issue and is not a solicitation of any offer to purchase any financial instrument, nor shall it or any part of it nor the fact of its distribution form the basis of, or be relied on, in connection with any contract or investment decision. Information and opinions contained in this document are published for the information of recipients, but are not to be relied upon as authoritative or taken in substitution for the exercise of judgment by any recipient, are subject to change without notice. In providing this document, BNPP does not offer investment, financial, legal, tax or any other type of advice to, nor has any fiduciary duties towards, recipients. Any reference to past performance is not indicative of future performance, which may be better or worse than prior results. Any hypothetical, past performance simulations are the result of estimates made by BNPP, as of a given moment, on the basis of parameters, market conditions, and historical data selected by BNPP, and should not be used as guidance, in any way, of future performance. To the fullest extent permitted by law, no BNPP group company accepts any liability whatsoever (including in negligence) for any direct or consequential loss arising from any use of or reliance on material contained in this document even where advised of the possibility of such losses. All estimates and opinions included in this document are made as of the date of this document. Unless otherwise indicated in this document there is no intention to update this document. BNPP may make a market in, or may, as principal or agent, buy or sell securities of any issuer or person mentioned in this document or derivatives thereon. Prices, yields and other similar information included in this document are included for information purposes however numerous factors will affect market pricing at any particular time, such information may be subject to rapid change and there is no certainty that transactions could be executed at any specified price. BNPP may have a financial interest in any issuer or person mentioned in this document, including a long or short position in their securities and/or options, futures or other derivative instruments based thereon, or vice versa. BNPP, including its officers and employees may serve or have served as an officer, director or in an advisory capacity for any person mentioned in this document. BNPP may, from time to time, solicit, perform or have performed investment banking, underwriting or other services (including acting as adviser, manager, underwriter or lender) within the last 12 months for any person referred to in this document. BNPP may be a party to an agreement with any person relating to the production of this document. BNPP may to the extent permitted by law, have acted upon or used the information contained herein or in the document, or the analysis on which it was based, before the document was published. BNPP may receive or intend to seek compensation for investment banking services in the next three months from or in relation to any person mentioned in this document. Any person mentioned in this document may have been provided with relevant sections of this document prior to its publication in order to verify its factual accuracy.

This document was produced by a BNPP group company. This document is for the use of intended recipients and may not be reproduced (in whole or in part) or delivered or transmitted to any other person without the prior written consent of BNPP. By accepting or accessing this document you agree to this.

BNP Paribas is a société anonyme incorporated in France, licensed and supervised as a credit institution by the European Central Bank (ECB) and as an investment services provider by the Autorité de contrôle prudentiel et de résolution (ACPR) and Autorité des marchés financiers (AMF), and having its registered office at 16, boulevard des Italiens, 75009 Paris, France.

Some or all of the information contained in this document may already have been published on <https://globalmarkets.bnpparibas.com>.

For country-specific disclaimers (United States, Canada, United Kingdom, Germany, Belgium, Ireland, Italy, Netherlands, Portugal, Spain, Switzerland, Brazil, Turkey, Israel, Bahrain, South Africa, Australia, China, Hong Kong, India, Indonesia, Japan, Malaysia, Singapore, South Korea, Taiwan, Thailand, Vietnam) please type the following URL to access the applicable legal notices: https://globalmarkets.bnpparibas.com/gm/home/Markets_360_Country_Specific_Notices.pdf

© BNP Paribas (2026). All rights reserved.

